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Courtesy: UAE Presidential Court

UAE LEADERS ATTEND IFTAR RECEPTION

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan and His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, attend an iftar reception at Shaikh Zayed farm with Their Highnesses Supreme Council Members and Rulers Dr Shaikh Sultan Bin Mohammad Al Qasimi of Sharjah, Shaikh Humaid Bin Rashid Al Nuaimi of Ajman, Shaikh Hamad Bin Mohammad Al Sharqi of Fujairah, Shaikh Saud Bin Rashid Al Mualla of Umm Al Quwain and Shaikh Saud Bin Saqr Al Qasimi of Ras Al Khaimah.

Dubai moves towards 20-minute city

Initiative aims to create smart, sustainable, and integrated urban spaces

DUBAI
BY ASHWANI KUMAR
Chief Reporter

The Supreme Committee for Urban Planning has approved Dubai's transit-oriented development (TOD) plan, which supports the '20-Minute City' concept. This strategic initiative aims

to optimise land use around Dubai Metro stations and create smart, sustainable, and integrated urban spaces. The plan strives to allow residents to meet their daily needs within 20 minutes using different modes of transport, thereby reducing reliance on private cars, enhancing the quality of life, and promoting environmental sustainability. "Efforts will drive development and investment in five urban centres, supporting economic diversification, business growth, and job creation. These initiatives will also ad-

dress housing and essential services, advancing the objectives of the '20-Minute City' concept while reinforcing Dubai's global leadership in urban planning through the adoption of innovative planning systems," Mattar Al Tayer, Chairman of the Supreme Committee for Urban Planning, said after the meeting. "The total value of projects benefiting from the facilitated approval process exceeds Dh55 billion, with a 60 per cent reduction in approval time for transactions involving development project lands."

SEE ALSO P2

PA ready to run Gaza, Abbas says at Arab summit

EGYPT'S AL SISSI SAYS PLAN IS TO SEE PALESTINIANS REMAIN ON THEIR LAND

CAIRO

Mahmoud Abbas said his Palestinian Authority was ready to reassume control over Gaza, as Arab leaders in Cairo yesterday hammered out a plan for rebuilding the devastated territory to counter a widely condemned proposal by US President Donald Trump.

The prospect of the PA governing Gaza was far from certain, however, with Israel having ruled out any future role for the body, and Trump having closed the Palestine Liberation Organisation liaison office in Washington during his first term while stepping up support for Israel.

On behalf of President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Shaikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister and Chairman of the Presidential Court, led the UAE delegation to the summit.

Global outrage

Shortly after returning to power in January, Trump triggered global outrage by suggesting the United States "take over" the Gaza Strip and turn it into the "Riviera of the Middle East",

while forcing its Palestinian inhabitants to relocate to Egypt or Jordan. Yesterday's Arab League summit in Cairo aimed to offer an alternative to that vision.

In his opening remarks, Egyptian President Abdul Fattah Al Sissi said his country's plan for Gaza would ensure Palestinians "remain on their land", but was careful not to criticise Trump.

Sissi said that under the Egyptian plan, Gaza would be run by a committee of Palestinian technocrats, "paving the way for the return of the Palestinian Authority to the Strip". A draft version of the Egyptian plan seen by AFP lays out a five-year roadmap with a price tag of \$53 billion.

A proposed early recovery phase, expected to last six months and cost \$3 billion, would focus on clearing unexploded ordnance and debris, and providing temporary housing, according to the draft. That would be followed by a \$20 billion initial reconstruction stage running until 2027 and focusing on rebuilding essential infrastructure and permanent housing. The next stage of reconstruction, extending to 2030 at an estimated cost of \$30 billion, aims to build more housing, infrastructure, and industrial and commercial facilities. — AFP

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IFTAR 18:26

Fajr	05:21	Shuruq	06:34
Dhuhr	12:33	Asr	15:53
Maghrib	18:26	Isha	19:40

IMSAK 05:11
Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah



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